

Hossein Shirdel

Builder of real systems with AI · automated trading

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Full site: every log, chart
and line of public code

For about a year I have been designing and building, with leading AI models such as Claude and GPT, a **five-part automated trading system** for MetaTrader 5: data download and cost measurement, a backtester, a trading robot, and a watchdog that looks after the robot day and night. When the backtest showed 825% profit and the live account lost money, I did not explain it away. I compared them trade by trade, **found the flaw in the backtest myself**, and rebuilt the system.

5	6,500+	3 months	6 years
parts, one system	lines of Python	live on a demo account	of 1-minute data

Project: an automated trading system



Watchdog highlight

Checks the robot's heartbeat every 60 seconds; if the robot closes or hangs, it restarts it, finds the cause in the Windows event log (updates, power loss, sign-outs, crashes) and reports it on the Bale messenger.

Trading robot

Runs the strategy on MetaTrader 5 and reports every action with its exact reason on Bale. It shares its decision engine with the backtester.

Backtester

Simulates on 1-minute candles with separate bid and ask, real spread and swap; Excel report and a reason funnel.

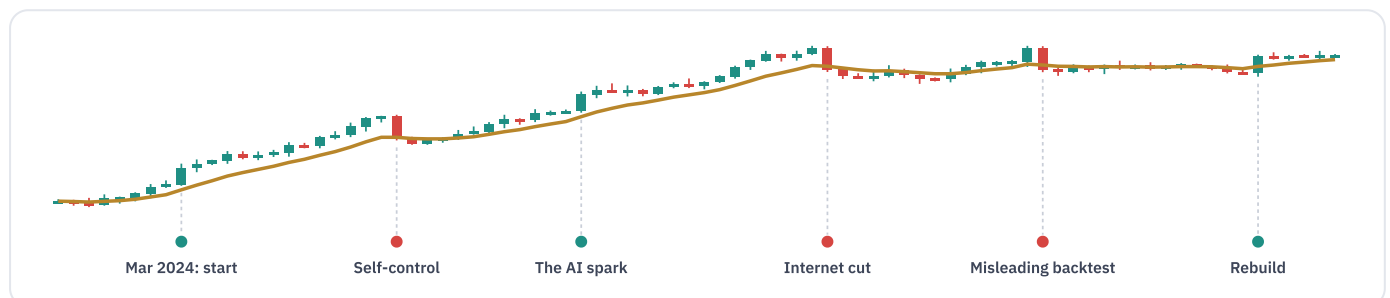
History downloader

Pulls 6 years of data from MetaTrader year by year and resumes if interrupted.

Spread meter

Measures the broker's real spread from thousands of ticks (median, not mean).

The journey at a glance



Illustrative: each candle is a step of the journey; green for progress, red for setbacks.

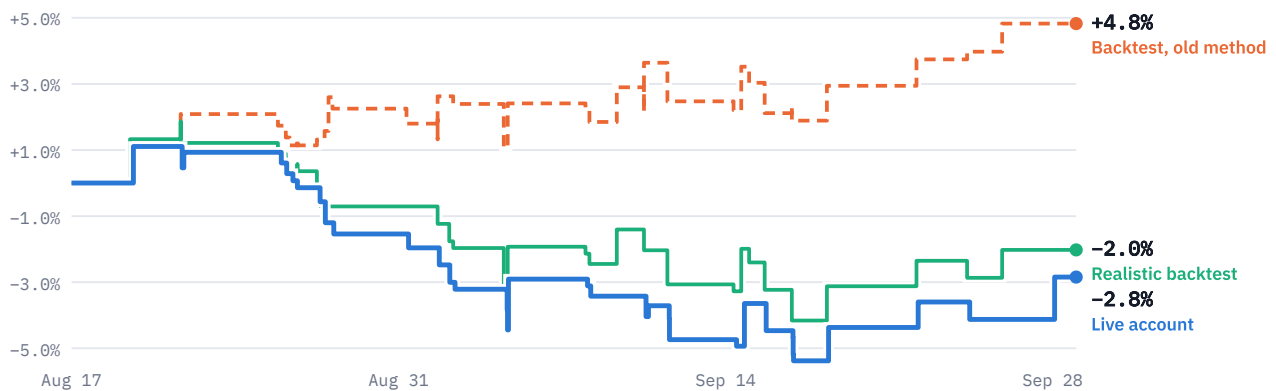
The biggest challenge: a backtest that fooled us for three months

One of the biggest dangers in building a trading robot is an **unrealistic backtest**. Our old backtest showed 825% profit over 6 years. The robot ran live for three months, but the results looked nothing like the backtest, and we had to rebuild the robot from scratch.

A trade-by-trade comparison showed that the robot's logic was right and the flaw was in the backtester. When an order filled inside a 4-hour candle, it assumed the candle's high and low happened **after** the entry, so it credited profits that really happened **before** the entry. The backtest could see the future.

Six weeks, three versions of the same trades

Cumulative return on a \$100,000 account, Aug 17 to Sep 28, 2026 (real data)



~~+77.6%~~ → -51.2%
two-year backtest, before and after fixing that one assumption

174 / 186
syncs where the orders on the account matched the backtest exactly

26 → 31 / 33
shared trades predicted correctly, before and after the fix

0.6%
chance of the live result if the old backtest had been right

What we did: rebuilt the backtester on 1-minute data with separate bid and ask, real spread and swap. The robot and the backtester now share one decision engine, and tests show their decisions match at every moment. My public backtester has a lock that refuses to run a strategy that sees the future. **Today** we are rebuilding the robot and re-running backtests with this new engine.

When the internet went national, the robot learned to talk

The robot was running on a virtual server when it went out of reach with no visible reason. Later I realized it was exactly when Iran's internet was cut to the national network and I could not reach the server. So I built an engine that sends every event, **complete and readable**, to the domestic messenger Bale: every order with its real risk, every cancellation with its exact reason, partial closes, daily reports, and watchdog messages.

Robot log

🗑 Order cancelled | zone AUDUSD_H4_00300 | sell
└ Order age: 59 minutes
└ Exact reason: daily trend up | H4 trend down
└ Next step: not re-placed

🔴 Robot down! No heartbeat for 15 minutes — restarting it now...

🐶 Watchdog: ✅ robot is back (last heartbeat 0.3 minutes ago).

Real logs from the previous robot on a demo account, translated from Persian

About me

March 2024

Into the markets and a year of daily practice. After one year at university I left to focus on this full time.

Insight

A trader's real problem is self-control, not strategy. Anton Kreil said trading's future belongs to AI, and I decided to combine the two.

The past year

Built the system with AI, ran it live for three months, found the backtest flaw, and rebuilt everything.

How I work

Today even experienced programmers write most of their code with AI. The scarce skill is knowing **what to build, how to prove it works, and when to doubt a result**. My role is system design, precise specification, testing and judgment.

1. Specify

every rule and edge case in plain, unambiguous language

2. Build with AI

the model writes the code; I direct structure and decisions

3. Test against known answers

synthetic data, a fake MetaTrader, cases with known results

4. Compare with reality

backtest versus live account, trade by trade

5. Fix and lock in

every fix ships with a test that keeps the mistake from returning

Skills

- Building real software systems with AI (Claude, GPT): design, specification, direction and testing
- Backtest design and validation: detecting look-ahead, reconciling backtests with live accounts
- Automated trading on MetaTrader 5; running robots on Windows virtual servers
- Monitoring and reporting: an automatic watchdog and full reports on the Bale messenger
- Price-action market analysis (supply and demand); about two and a half years of experience since March 2024
- Analyzing results in Excel reports

Personal details

Born	2004
Based in	Hamedan, Iran
Education	High-school diploma in computing, Shahid Motahari School, Fariman; one year of university, then left to focus on this project
Military service	Not yet completed
English	Basic

Working together

Arrangement	On-site or remote
Salary	Negotiable
Trial project	Happy to start with a short trial project, unpaid or at a negotiated rate

What I am looking for

I am looking for a role on an AI team, a startup or a fintech company, building tools and systems with AI, automating processes, and running backtests and analysis on market data.

Every detail is on the site

Real logs, the full chart, the 14 issues we found and logged, and full source for four public tools (history downloader, spread meter, backtester and watchdog).

claude.ai/artifact/Fxk1vwBMx9CHXirQA5yZ9Q#en

